Lesson 33

Weak/Tired

"Never tire of doing what is right."
(2 Thessalonians 3:13)

Weak: lacking in strength; vitality
Tired: worn out; lacking in energy

We all feel weak and tired at times. But feeling weary and exhausted is not always a bad thing. God can use our weakness to let his light shine through us. If we turn to God when we are tired and "burnt out," He will give us comfort and strength, show His mighty power, and refresh our hearts and souls.

Synopsis

We do not have to be physically or emotionally strong in order to serve God; in fact, it is to God's great delight that He uses the weak to shame the strong.[1] When we acknowledge our weakness and dependence on God, He can begin to work powerfully within us. The apostle Paul went so far as to boast about his weakness,[2] and delight in his hardships and difficulties.[3] He recognized that

God chose the weak things of the world
to shame the strong.
(1 Corinthians 1:27)[1]

Therefore I will boast all the more gladly about my
weaknesses, so that Christ's power may rest on me.
(2 Corinthians 12:9)[2]

That is why, for Christ's sake, I delight in weaknesses,
in insults, in hardships, in persecutions, in difficulties.
(2 Corinthians 12:10)[3]

when he was weak, and let God work through him, it was then that he became truly strong.[4]

If you are working for the Lord and feeling exhausted, do not give up. Never tire of doing what is right,[5] or grow weary doing good.[6] Try to keep your zeal for life and your spiritual fervor.[7] Put your hope in God and He will renew your strength.[8] Turn to the Lord and let Him recharge and energize your batteries.[9]

God's Guidance

If you are feeling weak and overwhelmed by life, look to the Lord and his might.[10] God promises that He will give strength to the weary and increase the power of the weak[11] He will reach down

For when I am weak, then I am strong.
(2 Corinthians 12:10)[4]

Never tire of doing what is right.
(2 Thessalonians 3:13)[5]

Let us not grow weary in doing good, for at the proper time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up.
(Galatians 6:9)[6]

Never be lacking in zeal, but keep your spiritual fervor, serving the Lord.
(Romans 12:11)[7]

Even youths grow tired and weary, and young men stumble and fall; but those who hope in the LORD will renew their strength.
(Isaiah 40: 30-31)[8]

To this end I labor, struggling with all his energy, which so powerfully works in me.
(Colossians 1:29)[9]

Look to the LORD and his strength; seek his face always.
(Psalm 105:4)[10]

He gives strength to the weary and increases the power of the weak.
(Isaiah 40:29)[11]

from heaven and take hold of us;[12] He will sustain us and make us great.[13] Regardless of our own human limitations and frailties, we are able to do all things through God who strengthens us.[14]

If you are tired and worn out, turn to God for rest.[15] Scriptures tell us that God is the only true source of rest and peace for our souls.[16] He alone can refresh our hearts and give us renewed energy for life.[17]

He reached down from on high and took hold of me;
he drew me out of deep waters.
(Psalm 18:16)[12]

You give me your shield of victory, and your right hand
sustains me; you stoop down to make me great.
(Psalm 18:35)[13]

I can do everything through him who gives me strength.
(Philippians 4:13)[14]

Come to me all you who are weary and burdened,
and I will give you rest.
(Matthew 11:28)[15]

My soul finds rest in God alone;
my salvation comes from him.
(Psalm 62:1)[16]

Refresh my heart in Christ.
(Philemon 1:20)[17]